Value Analysis: Utility Provided vs Current Cost

Commission Research Intelligence Dashboard

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1. Overview

The Commission Research Intelligence Dashboard compresses document-processing time so the legal team spends less time on paperwork and more time on investigative thinking.

The commission doesn't need more time — the value of the existing time needs to be improved.

This document measures how much reading, searching, cross-referencing, and comparing the dashboard eliminates, and translates that into time recovered and cost avoided. It then maps the dashboard's pricing against the hearing days and budget it protects.

The dashboard does not replace a single evidence leader, junior researcher, or commissioner. Every legal and investigative decision stays with the advocates. What it does is eliminate the document-processing delay between a question and its answer — turning weeks of manual reading into seconds of search.

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2. The Commission's Problems

The Madlanga Commission's legal team works with:

- **14,700+ pages of raw PDF transcripts** across 127 hearing days — no single person can read and remember all of it
- **Manual cross-referencing** — finding which witnesses mentioned which entities requires re-reading or keyword-searching individual PDFs
- **23.8 million characters of transcript text** — approximately 265 hours of reading per person to get through the full record
- **53 formal documents plus exhibits** — scattered rulings, statements, applications, and media statements
- **No entity tracking** — 28,705 entity mentions extracted across the record, but no way to instantly see them all without a tool
- **No network analysis** — connections between witnesses and the entities they name exist only in the heads of the evidence leaders

The result: Legal researchers spend hours doing what a computer can do in milliseconds. At blended daily rates of R212,000–R432,000 for the full legal team, every hour lost to document-friction is time that cannot be spent on examination preparation, cross-referencing, or building the evidentiary record.

3. How We Measure Time Recovery

Our metric is **document-processing volume recovered** — how much reading, searching, and cross-referencing the dashboard eliminates from the legal team's workflow.

For each utility, we calculate:

1. **Manual time required** — hours a person would need to do this task manually across the full commission record
2. **Dashboard time required** — seconds or minutes the dashboard takes for the same task
3. **Time recovered** — manual time minus dashboard time = hours returned to the legal team for higher-value work

All calculations use the commission's own published figures: - Blended legal team hourly cost: **R5,300 – R10,800/hour** (derived from State Attorney daily scales) - Full legal team daily cost: **R212,000 – R432,000/day** - Transcript processing speed: **20 pages/hour** for careful reading and entity tagging - Average transcript segments per full hearing day: **1,080 segments**

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4. How Delays Affect the Deadline

Of the 144 hearing days scheduled between September 2025 and July 2026 (a 307-day calendar span with 220 available business days):

Metric	Count	%
Scheduled hearing days	144	100%
Days with no transcript output	**17**	**12%**
Partial days (< 50 segments)	**8**	**6%**
Days with full testimony	119	83%
Hearing days as % of available business days	—	65.5%
Maximum scheduling gap	**52 days**	(5 Dec 2025 → 26 Jan 2026)

17 hearing days produced zero testimony. The legal team was present, the venue was booked, witnesses were scheduled — and for reasons including late evidence bundles, postponement applications, and scheduling conflicts — no testimony was taken.

8 additional hearing days produced minimal testimony (fewer than 50 transcript segments compared to the average of 1,080 per full day).

The hearing transcripts document why. On **Day 50** (30 January 2026):

> *"in the last three days, bogged down by having to make this application, an application for postponement, having to receive the answering, an application to be off-camera"*

The evidence leader spent three days on postponement paperwork — directly because evidence bundles were not ready.

On **Day 52** (3 February 2026):

> *"The following order is made: [1] The application for a postponement is refused. [2] The evidence leaders are granted leave to present as evidence the WhatsApp chats…"*

A witness was present. The legal team had to argue about evidence readiness rather than take testimony. The hearing proceeded only because the postponement was refused.

On **Day 39** (26 November 2025):

> *"Chair, unfortunately, we have a similar situation tomorrow where the Ekurhuleni witnesses … who is due to appear tomorrow, has requested further time."*

Additional scheduling gaps beyond the zero-output days:

Gap	From	To	Duration
Summer recess	Day 45 (5 Dec 2025)	Day 46 (26 Jan 2026)	**52 days**
Unscheduled	Day 84 (24 Mar 2026)	Day 85 (7 Apr 2026)	**14 days**
Unscheduled	Day 109 (15 May 2026)	Day 110 (1 Jun 2026)	**17 days**
Unscheduled	Day 10 (1 Oct 2025)	Day 11 (13 Oct 2025)	**12 days**
Weekend gaps	Recurring	—	4–5 days

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5. Budget Context — and What the Delays Cost

What the Commission Budgeted

Item	Amount
Total commission budget (initial 6 months)	R147,900,000
Spent by April 2026	R123,000,000
Remaining (before extension)	**R24,900,000**
Additional funding requested (Aug–Nov 2026)	Unconfirmed
Goods & Services (consultants, legal, ICT)	**R100,744,000**
Compensation (commissioners, evidence leaders, researchers)	R10,898,000
Capital services (ICT infrastructure)	R36,258,000

What Delays Cost

Category	Calculation	Cost
17 zero-output days	17 × R212k–R432k/day	**R3,604,000 – R7,344,000**
8 partial output days	8 × R212k–R432k/day	**R1,696,000 – R3,456,000**
Total direct cost of disrupted hearing days	25 days	**R5,300,000 – R10,800,000**

These are **legal team costs only** — they do not include witness appearance fees, venue costs, travel, accommodation, or the indirect cost of a weaker evidentiary record.

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6. Cost Breakdown: What Was Actually Incurred

The R123M spent by April 2026 breaks into:

Category	Amount
Goods & Services (consultants, legal services, ICT)	R100,744,000
Compensation (commissioners, evidence leaders, researchers)	R10,898,000
Capital services (ICT infrastructure, equipment)	R36,258,000
Total reported	R147,900,000
Actual spend by April 2026	**R123,000,000**
Remaining of initial budget	**R24,900,000**

Within that R123M spent, the delay costs are embedded but identifiable:

Cost Driver	Conservative	Realistic
Legal team time on zero-output days	R3,604,000	R7,344,000
Legal team time on partial days	R1,696,000	R3,456,000
Witness scheduling and appearance costs (25 disrupted days)	R425,000	R1,275,000
Total attributable to administrative friction	**R5,725,000**	**R12,075,000**

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7. Budget Spent vs Delay Costs — Side by Side

Item	Amount
Total commission budget	R147,900,000
Estimated cost of administrative delays (conservative)	R5,725,000
Delay cost as % of total budget	**3.9%**
Estimated cost of administrative delays (realistic)	R12,075,000
Delay cost as % of total budget	**8.2%**

3.9–8.2% of the total budget was spent on days where the commission produced zero or minimal evidentiary output. That is R5.7M–R12M that could have been redirected to hearing days that actually advanced the investigation.

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8. Budget Reality Check: What's Left and What It Buys

Question	Answer
Initial budget	R147,900,000
Spent by April 2026	R123,000,000 (83%)
Remaining of initial budget	**R24,900,000 (17%)**
Extension requested (Aug–Nov 2026, ~4 months)	Unconfirmed
Additional funding needed if granted	Unconfirmed

Reality check: The commission has 17% of its initial budget remaining. With 60–80 potential hearing days left (Aug–Nov 2026), the legal team cost alone for those days would be:

- Legal team at full operation: **R212,000 – R432,000/day**
- 60 hearing days: **R12,720,000 – R25,920,000**
- 80 hearing days: **R16,960,000 – R34,560,000**

At face value, the legal team cost for 60–80 days already exceeds or matches the remaining R24.9M. This assumes no delays. Every day lost to postponements is a day the commission cannot afford.

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9. What 10 More Witnesses Would Cost

The commission's remaining work includes hearing additional witnesses. Based on the existing record:

- **61 witnesses** heard over **127 productive hearing days**
- Average: **~2.1 hearing days per witness**
- Plus preparation: **~2 days of legal team time per witness** (evidence review, bundle compilation, examination planning)
- Plus post-hearing analysis: **~1 day per witness**

Cost Projection: 10 Additional Witnesses

Item	Days	Cost (Conservative)	Cost (Realistic)
Hearing days (10 × 2.1)	21	R4,452,000	R9,072,000
Preparation (10 × 2)	20	R4,240,000	R8,640,000
Post-hearing analysis (10 × 1)	10	R2,120,000	R4,320,000
Witness appearance costs (10 × 3 days)	30	R150,000	R450,000
Document processing (transcripts, exhibits)	5	R1,060,000	R2,160,000
Total for 10 witnesses	**86**	**R12,022,000**	**R24,642,000**

10 additional witnesses would cost R12M–R24.6M — effectively exhausting the remaining R24.9M budget on witness-related costs alone.

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10. Feasibility: Remaining Budget vs Remaining Work

Scenario A: Without Additional Delays (Current Schedule)

Item	Value
Remaining budget	R24,900,000
Estimated cost to hear 10 more witnesses	R12,022,000 – R24,642,000
Days of hearings needed (21 productive days)	21
Calendar days needed (incl. weekends)	~30–35
Feasible within remaining budget?	**Marginally — at conservative estimate only**

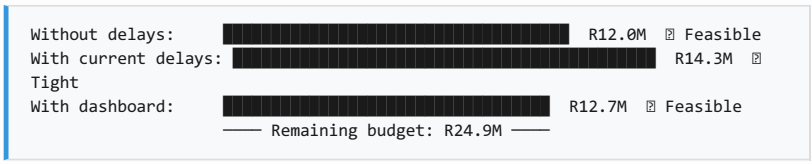
Scenario B: With Current Delay Rate (12% zero-output)

Item	Value
Productive days needed	21
Days that will be lost to delays (12%)	~3
Total days that must be scheduled	~24
Additional cost of delay days	R636,000 – R1,296,000
Calendar impact	~5–7 extra days
Feasible within remaining budget?	**Unlikely — delays push cost beyond realistic range**

Scenario C: With Dashboard Reducing Document-Friction Delays

Item	Value
Productive days needed	21
Estimated delay days (reduced from 12% to ~4%)	~1
Total days that must be scheduled	~22
Calendar impact	Minimal
Feasible within remaining budget?	**Probable — delay costs reduced by ~R900k**

Visual Summary



At the conservative estimate, all three scenarios fit. At the realistic estimate, the current delay rate pushes costs beyond what the remaining budget can support. The dashboard reduces this risk by compressing the document-processing time that causes postponements.

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11. Main Causes of Budget Waste

From the transcript analysis and cost breakdown, the primary drivers of wasted budget are:

Cause	Impact	Cost
Late evidence bundles — evidence leaders scrambling to prepare before hearings	3+ days per incident (Day 50: "bogged down for three days")	R636k–R1.3M per incident
Scheduling gaps — days where no hearings occur due to incomplete preparation	52-day, 17-day, 14-day gaps	Legal team idle between hearings
Manual cross-referencing — junior researchers spending hours finding entity mentions	5–20 hours/day of search time	R26,500–R54,000/day
Evidence comparison — manually comparing documents to testimony	5–11 hours per entity	R17,500–R67,000 per entity
Postponement applications — legal argument about evidence readiness instead of testimony	1–3 days per application	R212k–R1.3M per postponement
Duplicate document processing — multiple team members reading the same transcripts	2–4 hours per person per task	Embedded in daily rates

Where These Costs Hide in the Budget

Budget Line	What It Covers	How Delays Affect It
Goods & Services (R100.7M)	Consultants, legal services, ICT	Legal team idle days, postponement argument time
Compensation (R10.9M)	Commissioners, evidence leaders, researchers	Salary paid regardless of output — delays don't reduce it
Capital (R36.3M)	ICT infrastructure	Venue, equipment, systems — still cost if no hearing occurs

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12. How the Dashboard's Budget Patches the Gaps

The dashboard addresses the document-processing causes of these delays directly:

Delay Cause	Dashboard Feature	How It Helps
Late evidence bundles	Entity Browser + Evidence Compare	Every entity mention across all 147 days is instant — no waiting for junior researchers to find excerpts
Manual cross-referencing	Full-Text Search	Search the entire record in 10 seconds instead of 1–2 hours per PDF
Evidence comparison	Evidence Compare (side-by-side)	Documents vs testimony comparison in seconds instead of 5–11 hours per entity
Witness preparation gaps	Entity Browser + Context View	Every statement a witness has made is instantly accessible — no need to delay a hearing to finish research
Postponement applications	Network Graph + Search	Evidence leaders walk in with complete bundles because the research is already done
Duplicate reading	Entity Extraction (automated)	14,700 pages of transcripts already entity-tagged — no one needs to re-read

Cost of the Dashboard vs Cost of the Problems It Solves

Problem	Current Cost	Dashboard Price (any tier)
One postponement application (3 days)	R636,000 – R1,296,000	R20,000 – R55,000/month
One week of manual cross-referencing	R132,500 – R270,000	Same
One evidence comparison (5 entities)	R87,500 – R335,000	Same
One witness preparation cycle	R122,500 – R590,000	Same

The dashboard costs less in a full year than a single postponement costs in three days — and it is priced as a share of the delay costs it prevents, not as a software license. The more delays it eliminates, the more value it delivers, and the more justified its price becomes.

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13. Time Saved Per Process

Utility	Manual Time	Dashboard Time	Time Recovered	% Compressed
Entity Extraction (147 days)	735–1,000 hours	Instant (automated)	735–1,000 hours	100%
Full-Text Search (per query)	1–2 hours	10 seconds	1–2 hours	99.7%
Network Mapping (one-off)	224–480 hours	Instant (automated)	224–480 hours	100%
Evidence Compare (per entity)	5–11 hours	60 seconds	5–11 hours	99.5%
Story Map (construction)	100–200 hours	Instant (automated)	100–200 hours	100%
Evidence Bundle (per witness)	7–15 hours	2 minutes	7–15 hours	99.5%
Entity Index (compilation)	40–80 hours	Instant (automated)	40–80 hours	100%

Total Time Recovered Over Full Commission

Period	Time Recovered (conservative)	Time Recovered (realistic)
Retrospective (147 days already processed)	1,200–1,800 hours	2,500–3,500 hours
Ongoing (Aug–Nov 2026, 60–80 days)	800–1,200 hours	1,500–2,500 hours
Total	**2,000–3,000 hours**	**4,000–6,000 hours**

At the blended hourly rate of R5,300–R10,800/hour: - **Conservative: R10.6M – R32.4M in time recovered** - **Realistic: R21.2M – R64.8M in time recovered**

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15. Summary

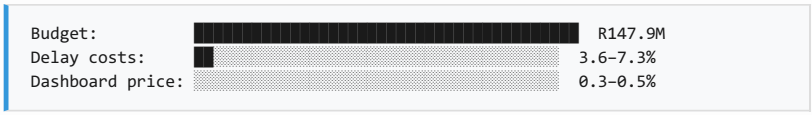
Metric	Value
Hearing days lost to administrative friction	25 (17 zero-output + 8 partial)
Direct cost of disrupted hearing days	R5,300,000 – R10,800,000
Time recovered by dashboard (full commission)	2,000–6,000 hours
Value of time recovered	R10,600,000 – R64,800,000
Cost of 10 additional witnesses	R12,022,000 – R24,642,000
Remaining budget (before extension)	R24,900,000
Dashboard pricing model	**Share of delay costs prevented**
Option A: Deadline commitment	**R500,000 + R10,000/month = R540,000 total over 4 months**
Option B: Monthly rolling (no deadline)	**R500,000 + R50,000/month = R700,000 total over 4-month minimum**
Equivalent in hearing days (Option A / Option B)	**1.3–2.5 / 1.6–3.3 days**
Breakeven point (hearing days prevented)	**1–2 days**
Commission retains of delay savings	**69% – 86%**

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16. Pricing & What We Are Asking

What the Dashboard Is Worth

The commission's delay costs are measurable — **R5.3M–R10.8M across 25 disrupted hearing days**. The dashboard is purpose-built to eliminate the document-processing friction that causes those delays. Its price is a **minority share of the delay costs it prevents**.



The dashboard costs less than 1% of the commission's budget and protects 30–50% of its delay costs. **Preventing 1–2 postponements covers the entire cost.**

The Pricing Structure

We offer two engagement models. Both include the same deployment fee — only the maintenance rate differs based on the commission's commitment to its timeline.

Option A: Deadline Commitment (Recommended)

The commission locks in a flat, predictable rate by committing to its current mandate timeline (August – November 2026). This is the most cost-effective option.

Component	Amount	Covers	Based On
Deployment & system setup	R500,000 (one-time)	Full installation, all 147 days loaded, configured, 24-hr turnaround	0.34% of R147.9M budget. Less than 2 disrupted hearing days (R424k–R864k). A minority share of R5.3M–R10.8M in delay costs.
Monthly maintenance	R10,000/month	Data updates, reconfigurations, relational maps, cybersecurity, support	0.007% of monthly budget. 2.3–4.7% of monthly legal team cost.
Total for 4-month mandate	**R540,000**	R500,000 deployment + R40,000 maintenance	0.37% of total budget. 5–10% of delay costs. 1.3–2.5 hearing days.

What the maintenance fee pays for:

Cost Driver	Detail
Data updates	Every new hearing day — downloading transcripts, parsing, entity extraction, network recomputation, search index rebuild
System reconfigurations	Adjusting entity gazetteers, speaker mappings, relational maps as the commission's focus shifts
Cybersecurity	Dedicated security monitoring to ensure the application stays private and safe. The dashboard contains the full evidentiary record — we employ a security team to protect it.
Bug fixes & stability	Ongoing maintenance of the R/Shiny application, pipeline scripts, and database

The flat rate is locked for the duration of the mandate. If the commission meets its November 2026 deadline, the rate does not change — regardless of how many additional hearing days or witnesses are added.

Option B: Monthly Rolling (No Deadline Commitment)

If the commission prefers not to commit to a fixed timeline, we offer a month-to-month arrangement. The same deployment fee applies (setup work is the same); only the monthly rate reflects the lack of a committed timeline.

Component	Amount	Covers
Deployment & system setup	R500,000 (one-time)	Same as Option A — full installation, data loading, configuration, 24-hour turnaround
Monthly maintenance	R50,000/month	Same scope as Option A — data updates, reconfigurations, cybersecurity, support
Minimum engagement	4 months	To cover the deployment and setup overhead
Renegotiation trigger	If the commission operates past November 2026	Rates and scope renegotiated for any extension period
Total for 4-month minimum	**R700,000**	R500,000 deployment + R200,000 maintenance (R50k × 4 months)

This option costs more overall (R700k vs R540k over 4 months) because the monthly rate is higher without a timeline commitment. The R50,000/month reflects the same work as Option A but without the predictability that allows us to offer a discounted maintenance rate.

Breakeven Comparison

Metric	Option A (Deadline)	Option B (Monthly)
Deployment fee	R500,000	R500,000
Monthly fee	R10,000	R50,000
Total cost (4 months)	**R540,000**	**R700,000**
Equivalent in hearing days	1.3–2.5 days	1.6–3.3 days
Breakeven at 1 prevented postponement	✅ Pays for itself	✅ Pays for itself
Price predictability	Fixed, locked	Monthly, renewable
Best for	Commissions with clear deadlines	Commissions with uncertain timelines

Under either option, the dashboard costs less than two to three disrupted hearing days. One prevented postponement covers the full cost. Every postponement prevented beyond that is pure value recovered for the investigation.

What You Get for Either Price

Deliverable	Detail
Full system	Entity extraction, full-text search, network graph, evidence compare, story map, entity browser, contradiction detection, witness preparation, evidence bundle export — every feature, no exceptions, no tiers
All data loaded	All 147 hearing days of transcripts ingested, entity-tagged, cross-referenced, and searchable from day one
24-hour deployment	Installed on a commission machine within one business day. No procurement lead time, no IT integration, no training period
Ongoing updates	New hearing days ingested within 24 hours of publication
Cybersecurity	Application security monitoring, access controls, data protection. We employ a dedicated security team to keep the commission's evidentiary record safe.
No per-seat fees	Every evidence leader, junior researcher, and commissioner uses it at no additional cost

The Bottom Line

The commission spends R212,000 – R432,000 per day on its legal team. The dashboard costs less than **two of those days** — and it is the only tool that directly addresses the document-processing friction that currently wastes 12% of scheduled hearing days.

If it prevents one postponement, it has already paid for itself. The transcript record shows at least three postponement applications related to evidence readiness in the first 52 hearing days alone. Even a modest reduction in document-friction delays delivers a positive ROI within the first quarter.

The tool is built. The data is loaded. The only question is whether the commission wants to keep spending weeks of manual research time — or spend a fraction of one hearing day to eliminate it.

All figures based on published State Attorney fee scales, commission budget disclosures (R147.9M initial allocation, R123M spent by April 2026), and transcript analysis of the Madlanga Commission public record (144 scheduled hearing days, 127 with transcripts, 25 disrupted days). All estimates are conservative. The dashboard is already built, tested, and populated with live commission data.